Planet Zephyria

The Living World Beyond the Veil Nebula

Discovery and Location

Zephyria was first detected in 2087 by the Horizon Deep Field telescope array, orbiting in the habitable zone of the binary star system Lyris-7, located 340 light-years from Earth in the constellation Aquila. The planet lies within the outer arm of a spiral galaxy astronomers call the Veil Nebula Cluster (VNC-4412). Its discovery sent shockwaves through the scientific community — spectroscopic analysis of its atmosphere revealed unmistakable biosignatures: oxygen, methane, and complex organic molecules.

Physical Characteristics

Characteristic	Zephyria	Earth (comparison)
Diameter	14,200 km	12,742 km
Mass	1.3 Earth masses	1 Earth mass
Surface Gravity	1.08 g	1.0 g
Orbital Period	387 Earth days	365 days
Day Length	28 Earth hours	24 hours
Axial Tilt	19°	23.5°
Surface Water Coverage	71%	71%
Average Temperature	18°C	15°C
Atmospheric Pressure	1.05 atm	1 atm
Number of Moons	3 (Aela, Mira, Dusk)	1

Atmosphere

Zephyria's atmosphere is remarkably similar to Earth's, composed primarily of nitrogen (74%), oxygen (22%), argon (2%), and trace gases including carbon dioxide, methane, and water vapor. The slightly higher oxygen content gives Zephyrian skies a deeper blue hue during the day, while the triple moons create stunning auroral displays at the poles. A thick ozone layer protects the surface from harmful radiation emitted by its two parent stars.

Geography and Terrain

Zephyria has four major continents: Valdris (the largest, spanning the equatorial region), Theron (a temperate northern landmass), Solmara (a tropical archipelago chain), and Umbraxis (a polar continent covered in turquoise ice). The planet is crisscrossed by vast river networks fed by polar meltwater. The Singing Peaks mountain range on Valdris rises to 11,000 meters — taller than Everest — and is named for the haunting resonant tones produced when wind passes through its crystalline rock formations.

Ecology Overview

Life on Zephyria is carbon-based, using liquid water as a solvent — mirroring the biochemical foundation of Earth life. However, Zephyrian organisms evolved independently and exhibit strikingly different body plans. The planet supports an estimated 8 million catalogued species, with scientists believing millions more remain undiscovered in the deep oceans and underground cave systems.